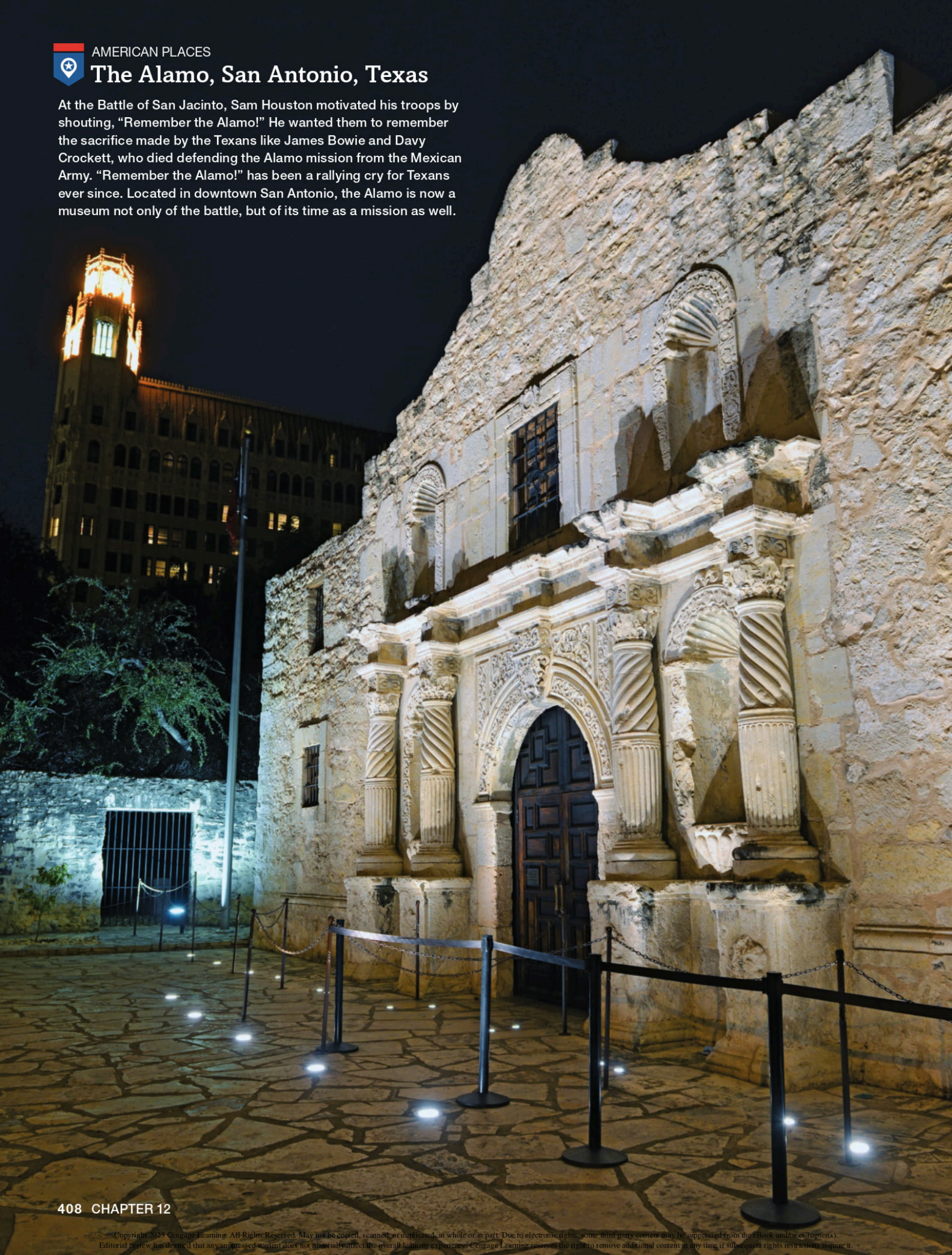
AMERICAN PLACES

The Alamo, San Antonio, Texas

At the Battle of San Jacinto, Sam Houston motivated his troops by shouting, “Remember the Alamo!” He wanted them to remember the sacrifice made by the Texans like James Bowie and Davy Crockett, who died defending the Alamo mission from the Mexican Army. “Remember the Alamo!” has been a rallying cry for Texans ever since. Located in downtown San Antonio, the Alamo is now a museum not only of the battle, but of its time as a mission as well.



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2.2 Settlement and Rebellion

Inviting new friends to your home for a party can sometimes lead to unexpected surprises. Mexico thought that inviting Americans to move to Texas would boost the population. It didn't anticipate what would happen next.

MAIN IDEA Cultural differences and disagreements with the Mexican government led Texans to declare independence from Mexico.

GROWING NUMBER OF SETTLERS

With the opportunity to own a great deal of land in exchange for a small fee, thousands of Americans arrived in Tejas—or Texas, as they called the territory—to take advantage of Mexico's settlement policies. Here, women were able to inherit land grants, and many owned and ran huge, profitable ranches. Women worked alongside men in the day-to-day operations of raising and selling livestock.

Texas quickly became a mix of cultures. Most American settlers were English-speaking Protestants, and the vast majority of Mexicans were Spanish-speaking Catholics. American settlers continued the practice of slavery in Texas, even though Mexico had outlawed slavery in 1829.

Though it had invited American settlement, the Mexican government grew concerned as the population of Texas became more American and less Mexican. By 1830, about 21,000 Americans lived there, including about 1,000 enslaved African Americans. On April 6, 1830, Mexico banned all further American settlement in Texas. Many European countries had already outlawed slavery, and the Mexican government hoped that a stronger European presence would encourage an end to the practice of slavery in the territory.

Texans—Americans and Tejanos alike—who disliked these changes called for more representation within the Mexican government. Revolts in 1832 and 1833 sent the message: Texans wanted Texas statehood within Mexico. General **Antonio López de Santa Anna**, who had recently become the president of Mexico, rejected this demand. Texans rebelled and the Texas War for Independence began.

TEXAS WAR FOR INDEPENDENCE

The war started in October 1835 with the Battle of Gonzales, a victory for Texas. More battles followed, and Santa Anna soon led an army from Mexico City to put down the rebellion. He reached San Antonio by mid-February 1836, where he encountered roughly 180 Texans guarding the **Alamo,** a mission building. For 13 days, 1,800 Mexican soldiers held the Alamo and its defenders under **siege**, which meant no one could leave or enter the building to bring food, supplies, or reinforcements. On March 2, Texans declared themselves a separate nation, the Republic of Texas. On March 6, the Mexican Army breached the Alamo's walls and killed almost everyone inside, including frontiersmen James Bowie, designer of the Bowie knife, and Davy Crockett, a U.S. congressman.

In response, on April 21, **Sam Houston**, the Texan Army's commander, attacked the Mexican Army near the San Jacinto River. He won the **Battle of San Jacinto** (sahn hah-SEEN-toh) and captured Santa Anna. Santa Anna agreed to withdraw and surrender. Texas had achieved independence.

HISTORICAL THINKING

1. **READING CHECK** Why did Texans want independence from Mexico?
2. **ANALYZE CAUSE AND EFFECT** How did the Texans' defeat at the Alamo affect the final outcome of the Texas War for Independence?
3. **DESCRIBE** What opportunities did Tejas offer women who settled and lived there?

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